Ziying Wang (Audrey)
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EDUCATION

Duke Kunshan University (DKU) & Duke University Dual Degree Class of 2027
B.S. in Computation and Design; Computer Science Track (DKU) Kunshan, China
B.S. in Interdisciplinary Studies; Computation and Design; Computer Science (Duke) Durham, U.S.
Cum GPA: 3.778/4.0

- Courses: Introduction to Programming and Data (A); Computation, Society & Culture (A); Introduction to Database (A); Elements of Machine Learning (A +); User Research Methods (A)

PUBLICATION

- **Wang, Ziying**, and Yucheng Jin. "Generative Art in Your Pocket: User Perception and Acceptance of AI-Generated Abstract Art for Mobile Wallpapers." *Proceedings of the Twelfth International Symposium of Chinese CHI*. 2024. (accepted)
- Li, Molin*, **Ziying Wang***, Yifan Zhao, Sidong Wang, Ray LC, and Xian Xu. "Feathers, Fins, and Forgotten Joints: Performer Improvisation Strategies with Nonhuman Avatars in Motion Capture-mediated Dance." *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*. (Under Review) (**Equal Contribution*)
- **Ziying Wang**, Yihong Lin, Xianglin Zhao, Yirui Huang, Ziya Zhou, Wei Xue, Wanling Cai, and Yucheng Jin. "EmotiStage: Designing an Emotion-Driven Performance System with Multi-modal Generative AI to Support Emotional Awareness." In *Proceedings of the ACM International Conference on Multimodal Interaction* (ICMI 2026). (accepted)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research on User Perception and Acceptance of AI-Generated Abstract Art in Mobile Wallpapers June 2024-Nov 2024
Student Research Assistant to Dr. Yucheng Jin, Assistant Professor of Computer Science *Kunshan*, China

- Conducted advanced statistical analysis on experimental data from a study involving 34 participants, utilizing tools such as Stata to perform binomial tests, paired t-tests, and linear regression to evaluate user preferences for AI-generated vs. human-designed mobile wallpapers.
- Contributed to the writing and editing of a peer-reviewed conference paper.

Research on Multi-modal Generative AI for Emotional Awareness (First Author) May 2025-Jan 2026
Student Research Assistant to Dr. Yucheng Jin, Assistant Professor of Computer Science *Kunshan*, China

- Led the end-to-end development of a full-stack interactive system that leverages multi-modal Generative AI (LLMs, music generation, and image synthesis) to facilitate psychological self-distancing and emotional regulation.
- Engineered the system architecture using Vue.js for the frontend and FastAPI for the backend; integrated OpenAI APIs and local music generation models to achieve real-time text-to-performance transformation.
- Designed and executed a mixed-methods user study involving semi-structured interviews and standardized scales; performed thematic analysis and quantitative evaluations to validate the system's efficacy in improving emotional clarity.
- Authored the full research paper as the lead author; the paper was accepted as a full paper at ACM ICMI 2026.

Research on Embodied Interaction & Non-human Avatars (Co-First Author) May 2025-Jan 2026
Student Research Assistant to Dr. Ray LC (CityU HK), Assistant Professor of Creative Media *HongKong*, China

- Developed a motion capture-mediated system to investigate the interaction between human performers and heterogeneous non-human avatars (e.g., eagle, fish), implementing real-time motion retargeting pipelines.
- Conducted a qualitative study with professional dancers to explore improvisation strategies under non-anthropomorphic morphological constraints; utilized Thematic Analysis to identify key adaptation patterns in bodily expression.
- Co-authored the research paper "Feathers, Fins, and Forgotten Joints," contributing to both the system design and empirical analysis; the work is currently under review at the International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI).

Research on AI-Supported Rehearsal for Stand-Up Comedy Performance (Second Author) Jan 2026-Present
Student Research Assistant to Dr. Zhicong Lu (GMU), Assistant Professor of Computer Science *Fairfax*, VA

- Built the front-end system for Thalia Studio, an interactive rehearsal support tool that connects script writing, recorded performance, moment-level AI feedback, and retrieved video examples within a single workflow.
- Implemented the writing area, performance recording interface, and moment-centered feedback panel using HTML, CSS, and vanilla JavaScript, with drag-and-drop material reorganization and in-browser rehearsal capture.
- Designed and conducted a user study with 12 comedy performers and enthusiasts, including semi-structured interviews and a customized post-task questionnaire combining the System Usability Scale and Creativity Support Index items.

Research on Generative AI-Powered UI Design Tool for Figma (Co-First Author) May 2026-Present
Student Research Collaborator with Dr. Jason Wu (Purdue), Assistant Professor of Computer Science *West Lafayette*, IN

- Built a Figma plugin using TypeScript, Preact, and create-figma-plugin that generates multiple UI design variants via LLM APIs from reference artboards and design specifications, with session logging to capture designer selection and edit data for training a preference model.
- Integrated a Siamese network discriminator (fine-tuned SigLIP2 backbone) provided by collaborator Jason Wu, deploying it as a local FastAPI service that scores generated variants against the reference artboard by cosine similarity, completing a functional end-to-end generation-and-scoring pipeline.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (bilingual proficiency)
Skills:
Research

- Methodologies: Mixed-Methods Research (Quantitative & Qualitative), Experimental Design, Usability Testing (SUS, PETS scales), Thematic Analysis, Semi-structured Interviews.
- Analysis: Statistical Analysis (Stata, Binomial tests, Paired t-tests, Linear Regression), Data Visualization, User Feedback Interpretation, Academic Writing.

Programming & Technology

- Languages & Frameworks: Python, Java, Vue.js, FastAPI, JavaScript, HTML/CSS.
- AI & Creative Tech: Generative AI Integration (OpenAI API, LLMs, Text-to-Image/Music Models), Prompt Engineering, Motion Capture Systems, Real-time Motion Retargeting, 3D Modeling (Blender).
- Plugin Development: Figma Plugin API, create-figma-plugin
- Tools: Stata, Git, LaTeX, Adobe Creative Suite.

Interests: Violin (Professional)